

— EDITION 05

PREGAME: USA VS PARAGUAY — THE HOSTS OPEN

16 years away. Paraguay are back — and the USA open at home.

A 7-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 07

| USA V PARAGUAY.

Group D · SoFi Stadium, Los Angeles · Friday
June 12 · 6:00 PM ET. *The hosts open their
home World Cup under the California lights.*

0202 / 07

| PARAGUAY ARE BACK.

Sixteen years away. Their first World Cup since 2010 — and they earned it the hard way, beating Brazil, Argentina and Uruguay on the road to qualifying. *Nobody wanted to draw them.*

0303 / 07

| THE TURNAROUND.

Gustavo Alfaro took over after Copa America 2024 and turned Asunción into a fortress, dragging Paraguay from a dismal start to 6th in CONMEBOL. *Built on grit, not gloss.*

0404 / 07

| THE HOST'S TALISMAN.

Christian Pulisic — captain, and the face of US Soccer's golden generation, carrying a nation's expectation on home soil. *The Azteca had its night. SoFi wants its own.*

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| THE DANGER MEN.

Miguel Almirón is Alfaro's focal point in a shifting 4-4-2, with Brighton's Julio Enciso breaking from deep. *Paraguay don't just defend anymore.*

0606 / 07

| THE STAKES.

Host nations carry history into openers — but Paraguay arrive as Group D's dark horse, not its makeweight. *Expectation against a side with nothing to lose.*

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| YOUR CALL. SAVE THIS BRIEF.

Home pressure, a 16-year comeback, and a group that just got interesting. *Drop your scoreline in the comments — we archive the verdicts at full time.*

— THE TAKEAWAY

WHO TAKES IT AT SOFI?

Scoreline in the comments — and follow @fifa.archv for the daily tournament archive.